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# **John Mulaney Had One Moment at the Emmys Too Hot for NBC. It Was the Best Part of the Show.**

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# John Mulaney Had One Moment at the Emmys Too Hot for NBC. It Was the Best Part of the Show.

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Move over, ladies, because tonight is a night for oppressed men! Or so John Mulaney would have you think with his crowd-crushing bit at the 78<sup>th</sup> Primetime Emmy Awards. The ceremony—which aired on NBC on Monday night instead of the usual Sunday to avoid [a scheduling conflict with Sunday Night Football](#)—had a lot of surprising moments. For starters, the evening was hosted not by a comedian but by the one and only Mariska Hargitay, the longtime [Law & Order: SVU](#) star lately known for her supporting role on the sideline of the Knicks' championship run. Then a bunch of other unexpected things happened: [The Diplomat](#)'s Allison Janney won best supporting actress in a drama over [The Pitt](#)'s Katherine LaNasa; an award was presented in [High Valyrian](#); and Megan Stalter of *Hacks* was dressed like an Emmy, which is to say she was painted head to toe in gold body paint, which must've made for an interesting shower later on.

- Video from Slate

But the most shocking moment of the evening was Mulaney absolutely stealing the show with what may be the funniest bit ever performed to present an award.

Mulaney went onstage to hand out the trophy for Outstanding Lead Actor in a Drama Series, but instead of doing it straight or performing a stale skit, [the stand-up comedian](#) decided to dedicate a few minutes to a tongue-in-cheek speech bringing awareness to men's oppression in Hollywood. "Finally something for the fellas," Mulaney started. "What a crop of prom kings we have. They're not soft like the dad from *Bluey*, no." He deadpanned: "Since the creation of television, men have been historically underrepresented," a line that nominee Sterling K. Brown seemed to find particularly hilarious.

"For the first three years TV existed, there were no men on it. It was just beauty contests and children talking to hand puppets, until the early '60s, until a man walked out and said, 'Enough! My name is Fonzie, and the president's been shot!' " Mulaney joked, playing on Henry Winkler's *Happy Days* character and Gaeton Fonzi, who [investigated the Kennedy assassination](#).

"But let's talk about these bros tonight, these sweat hogs," he pivoted, before ribbing on the annoyance of [male actors' propensity for method acting](#), saying, "Some of the men in this category do method acting, and some do regular, less annoying acting." Mulaney didn't stop there, going on to mock the variety of roles the nominees of the category represent, stating, "And they can play anything, these nominees, not just doctors. They can play a cop, or an FBI agent, or a secret agent, and then that's it, no other examples."

But that wasn't the real moment that stopped the show or the one that seemed to send nominee

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Noah Wyle’s wife hiding for her life. No, the crown jewel of Mulaney’s bit were his props and his references, especially his reiteration—which will go down in Emmys history—of an infamous debate sparked by the hip-hop producer DJ Khaled: “I believe it was DJ Khaled who said, ‘[Real men don’t go down on their wives](#).’ But these nominees know that that is BS. They know there’s often less pressure on them if they do that first.” (Hear, hear! The Emmys, naturally, bleeped the moment.)

[embedded content]

The gags didn’t stop there. Mulaney then pulled out a book, which he had borrowed from the Glendale Public Library. That book was, of course, a self-help treatise written by Frank Vincent—known for his work with Martin Scorsese and on *The Sopranos*—who in 2006 published [A Guy’s Guide to Being a Man’s Man](#) (the cover of which is exactly what you’d expect it to be). Mulaney read an excerpt from the text: “A man’s man can be wearing the best clothes, drinking the finest wine, sitting with the most beautiful woman in Las Vegas, but if he doesn’t treat everyone around him with respect and class, he’s not a real man’s man, he’s just a jabroni in a good suit.” And with no transition, Mulaney then announced the nominees.

Wyle would go on to win the award for his work on the hit medical procedural *The Pitt*, but Mulaney would go on to win the night for his hilarious subversion of today’s culture wars debate about misogyny and masculinity—and for supporting his local library.

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